



International Diabetes Federation

Statement by The Global Coalition for Circulatory Health on WHO work in health emergencies



The 150th session of the World Health Organization (WHO) Executive Board (24–29 January 2022) discussed a report by the Director General on strengthening WHO preparedness for and in response to health emergencies. The Global Coalition for Circulatory Health, of which IDF is a member, released the following statement in relation to the report:

People living with circulatory conditions are disproportionately impacted by the COVID-19 pandemic. The lack of attention to non-communicable diseases (NCDs) in the early stages of the pandemic impeded their inclusion in strategic response plans and few countries included NCDs as part of essential health services packages. This has resulted in a deadly interplay between the NCD epidemic and the COVID-19 pandemic.

NCDs including hypertension, kidney disease, diabetes, stroke, and other circulatory conditions must be a top priority in preparedness, response, readiness and coordination activities and agreements at global, regional and country levels.

As such, our organisations, representing the global circulatory health community (those most impacted by COVID-19), call on WHO Member States to:

- Prioritize ongoing prevention, screening, and treatment for circulatory conditions in national COVID-19 response and recovery plans through patient co-creation.

- Increase domestic allocation of resources and develop targeted policies to tackle CVD and NCD risk factors, including the commercial determinants of health, through mechanisms such as taxation of unhealthy commodities.
- Integrate monitoring and data collection on NCD prevalence, comorbidities, and risk factors into measures of pandemic readiness, resilience, and response.
- Strengthen Primary Health Care and invest in family medicine to ensure equitable access to essential health services, particularly for people living with NCDs and in low-resource settings.
- Strengthen the NCD component of emergency preparedness and response by formalizing these actions in a WHO convention, agreement or international instrument on pandemic preparedness.

These steps would go far in making health systems more resilient and are expanded upon in our position paper - *Preventing the Next Pandemic: The Case for Investing in Circulatory Health*¹. We look forward to working with WHO Member States to prevent, and where necessary, respond to future health emergencies.

1. Available at <https://www.idf.org/our-activities/advocacy-awareness/resources-and-tools/170-preventing-the-next-pandemic-the-case-for-investing-in-circulatory-health.html>